The noble art of courting a moon princess

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/67481571.

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The noble art of courting a moon princess

by Bagge

Summary

When Micah falls in love, the Kick Ass Squad (and sis) immediately turn the courting of Princess Angella into a group project

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

"Friends! Sister!" Micah said, voice trembling as he addressed the rest of the self-named 'Kick ass squad'. "I have a grave announcement to make. You might want to sit down for this."

"You're in love," Spinnerella said.

"You're in love," Netossa smirked.

"You're and idiot. also, you're in love," Casta grinned.

"I'm in love!" Micah announced. "And you will never guess with who."

"The princess," Spinnerella said.

"The princess," Netossa said.

"The princess," Casta said, not entirely managing to hide the jealous undertone of her voice.

"The princess!" Micah exclaimed.

"High five, buddy!" Spinnerella held up her hand.

"You're so out of your depth," Netossa sighed and shook her head.

"*She's* so out of your *league*," Casta objected.

"I know!" Micah cried as he high fived Spinnerella. "That's why I'm coming to you. I need help."

The other three perked up. Now he was talking their language.

"A scheme?" Spinnerella said hopefully.

"A plot?" Netossa asked.

"Makeover?" Casta breathed, something almost frighteningly intense in her eyes.

"Ooooooooooor maybe I'll just forget the whole thing and live a life in celibacy instead," Micah said, alarm bells ringing.

"Nope, too late!"

"A plot it is!

"A scheme," Spinnerella pedantically corrected.

"You'll be so *pretty*!" Casta summoned an illusion of what surely *had* to be a joke costume. No real life human could ever wear that much frills. Right?

Right?

"First, I have to figure out how to approach her," Micah said, ignoring the looming prospect of makeover.

"The princess is... dignified," Spinerella said, a bit of caution in her voice.

"She's *refined*," Casta ammended.

"She's a total bitch," Netossa clarified. "Whaaat?" she added when the others turned to look at her.

"It's not being a bitch if you're a princess," Micah explained. "It's good breeding."

"Yeah, and what does that make us? Chopped liver?" Netossa crossed her arms.

"You're cool," Micah explained. "Totally different thing."

"I can live with 'cool'."

"Right," Casta said with determined voice. "The first thing we need to do is for Micah to..."

"Impress her?" Micah filled in.

"Talk to her like a human being," Spinnerella amended.

"Be able to form sentences in her general vicinity?" Netossa said to reduce the expectations to a reasonable level.

"No," Casta said with determined voice. "Makeover. We've been through this."

"What's wrong with the way I look now," Micah said, slightly hurt.

"Your clothes," Spinerella said without loosing a beat.

"Your beard," Netossa added.

"Yourself." Casta shook her head. "We have our work cut out for us. But don't worry, big brother - we're with you all the way."

"Actually, I think I'll get lost at sea instead," Micah cried, but too late. The makeover descended upon him like a tornado, leaving him with about as much agency and sense of direction as the real deal would have done.

Netossa, Spinnerella and Castaspella stood around the trembling sorcerer in a semicircle, critically examining their handiwork. Micah was dressed in purple braies with red slits. He had a white, frilled shirt with extravagantly poofed sleeves and generous display of chest. On his hat was a wide hat with a purple feather.

And there was a codpiece.

A *conspicuous* codpiece.

A *very* conspicuous codpiece.

"Guys..."

"Could have been worse," Spinnerella generously said.

"Could hardly have been better," Casta ungenerously said.

"It has to do," Netossa pragmatically said. "All right, Micah. Let us hear an opening line."

"A what?"

"An opening line," she patiently said. "Here, Casta will be the princess - for a short moment standing by herself and thinking of her perfect looks or whatever elemental princesses think of. You saunter up and say..."

"Why does Casta have to be the princess?"

"Yeah, why do I have to be the princess?"

"Because I sure as hell won't be, and you hitting on my girlfriend is just plain wrong."

"So me hitting on my sister isn't?"

"Just for your information, I'm way out of your league, bro."

"So is the princess. You'll do just fine."

Micah sighed but - correctly - inferred that he wasn't going to get out of the situation without further humiliation. He sauntered up to Casta who had given into the role by assuming a haughty expression.

"Hello, princess," he said with his best suave voice and swept his hat from his head. "Are those..."

"Ugh, vhy does this filthy *peasant* approach the royal person?" Casta glared at Micah through her nostrils. "Throw him in the dungeon as an example for others."

"Come on, give me a chance," Micah complained.

"Stop laughing, Netossa," Spinnerella said despite barely being able not to laugh herself.

"No, no, I think Casta captured her perfectly." Neotssa fistbumped the happily grinning Casta who obviously was very pleased with herself.

"Honestly, I'm not sure they have dungeons in Brightmoon," Spinnerella mused.

"You have to let me at least talk to her," Micah said.

"I can't see why she'd want to talk to you, though," Casta said.

"Because of his good looks?" Spinnerella suggested.

They critically looked him over.

"Because of his... charm?" Netossa suggested.

Another pregnant pause of judging looks.

"You are not doing the best for my self esteem here, guys," Micah muttered.

"Sorry," Spinnerella said. She turned to the others. "He's right - we are not being very supportive. We all know Micah has tons of good sides. All we have to do is to make sure she sees them."

"You're right," Netossa agreed, and even Casta nodded.

"That's right!" Micah said with more gusto. I can do this!"

"You can do this, bro," Casta echoed at the same time as Netossa said "You got this!"

They all nodded confidently at each other.

After a few moments, Micah sheepishly raised his hand.

"Um, I'm glad we're all on the same page here, that I have many good sides that will make the princess be attracted to me. Just for the sake of clarity though, I wonder if you could help me remember one or two of them."

They looked at each other.

"Um... you're pretty good with magic?" Casta said after a few moments.

"Thanks sis," he said and conjured an illusion of a brightly glowing flower from thin air. "But am I really good enough with magic to impress an elemental princess?"

They looked at each other again.

"You... can be funny?" Netossa suggested.

"That's good, right?" Micah hopefully said. "Women like men that make them laugh, right?"

"Well... Nettossa amended.

"Sometime..." Casta carefully admitted.

"Just don't overdo it," Spinnerella advised.

"Hello there, princess," Micah said with faux suave voice to Casta who took a step back and hissed at him. "Did you hear the one about the pirate, the maker and the..."

"Nope," Netossa interrupted. "I'm putting a stop to this right here."

"Micah, sweetie," Netossa said with her friendliest voice. "You can be *unintentionally* funny. Just don't try to force it."

"*Please* don't try to force it," Casta shuddered.

"You didn't even let me get to the punchline," Micah muttered, voice hurt.

"You can tell by how I didn't punch you," Casta nastily said.

"You *are* a charming guy," Spinnerella said with kind voice. "Just try to be yourself."

"Er..." Netossa said.

"Are we sure that..." Casta begun.

"Myself?" Micah asked. "I can do that." He leaned forward towards Casta again and lowered his voice a pitch.

"Why, hello there princess. This must be the time of the First Ones because I can clearly see a star."

He held Casta's gaze for a few moments, and then looked up at Spinnerella and Netossa with a goofy grin. "Eh? Eh?"

"Um..." Netossa said.

"It wasn't *offensively* terrible," Casta carefully said.

"You can be *unintentionally* charming," Spinnerella corrected herself. "Just *be* yourself without trying.

Micah furrowed his brow.

"How am I supposed to do that?"

They looked at each other.

"Maybe he just needs something to take his mind off the business at hand," Netossa said slowly.

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"For the record, I think this is a terrible idea," Micah complained.

"Duly noted," Netossa lightly said. "Now approach the princess and do whatever comes naturally."

"But not *too* naturally," Casta quickly chimed in.

"OK," Micah said. He took a deep breath and walked up to Casta. "Hello there, princess."

She gave him a cold look, but regally nodded as signal that he was allowed to keep speaking.

"I couldn't help to notice that..." Micah's voice trailed off as Netossa casually stepped up to him. He gave her a suspicious look, but she didn't interfere in the conversation.

Casta arched an eyebrow."Yes, little sorcerer?"

"I'm not that little!" Micah protested, and then immediately clamped his hands over his mouth. "No, I mean...."

"I get your meaning perfectly well, *little* sorcerer," Casta said, this time managing to mimic Princess Angella's inflections perfectly.

"Please!" Micah cried, red in his face. "You have too..."

"EAT WATER BALLOON!" Netossa cried and pulled a water balloon from her sleeves, hitting him straight in the face.

"That was the dorkiest thing EVER!" Casta laughed. "Please don't ever say that to the princess."

"You try coming up with clever lines while expecting to be ambushed," Micah muttered. He did a little spell to dry the water off him.

Netossa filled another water balloon. "If getting drenched is the worst the princess will do to you, you can count yourself lucky. Now up on the horse again, lover boy."

"I maintain this is a terrible plan," Micah muttered, but he dutifully stepped up to Casta again. "Hi, princess. I couldn't help notice your stunning looks and beautiful voice and nice nose and... HEY!"

"Don't just blab random lines like that." Spinnerella walked up to them, having hit him with a water balloon from ten paces away. "Your goal is actual conversation, not to break the record of number of compliments per minute."

"If you keep splashing me, I have no choice but to get the lines out quickly." Micah dried himself with another spell.

"Less is more, lady-killer. Less is more."

"Fiiiiine." Micah sighed and turned to Casta again. "Princess, you seem to... COME ON!"

"Got him!" Casta happily said. She dried her hands on the dress.

Micah shook himself like a dog to get the water out. "There MUST be a better way than this."

Netossa snorted and put her water balloon away. "Yeah? Like what."

"Like this." Micah turned to Casta again, took her hands and looked her in the eyes.

"Princess Angella, meeting you has already made this a night to remember. Forgive me if I step out of line, but if I could be so bold to ask you for a dance, it would make me the happiest man in all of Etheria."

He gently held her hands while he steadily looked Casta in the eyes, a hopeful smile on his lips. After a moment she looked away, blushing.

"That was... OK," she mumbled.

"It might actually do," Netossa reluctantly said.

"You got this, Micah," Spinerella generously said.

"I do, don't I?" he beamed. He let go of Casta's hands and pumped a fist in the air. "This will work! Thank you guys. You're the best. Wish me luck."

He hurried away.

Casta, Spinnerella and Netossa looked after him.

"Say what you will about Micah," Spinnerella commented. "He doesn't lack courage."

"They say you miss all the shots you don't take..." Netossa mused.

"Do you guys actually think he can pull it off?" Casta wondered, slightly worried.

There was a long, thoughtful pause.

"He's not entirely bad looking..." Spinnerella carefully said.

"And not entirely devoid of charm..." Netossa filled in.

"I guess she could do worse," Casta admitted. "Not much worse," she quickly amendment. "But worse."

There was another long silence. In the distance they could hear the trumpets that signalled that guests were starting to gather for the royal ball.

"He'll need us to look after him, though," Netossa said.

"Of course!" Spinnerella agreed. "Who knows what kind of trouble he will get into without us."

"Hey, wait for me!" Casta cried and struggled to keep up with the other two as they made their way down the street and towards the castle.

End Notes

Just like the Best Friends Squad a generation later, the Kick Ass Squad (and sis) all share one braincell which they happily refuse to use.

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!